

From: "Cian Mac Liatháin" </O=EXCHANGELABS/OU=EXCHANGE
ADMINISTRATIVE GROUP (FYDIBOHF23SPDLT)/CN=RECIPIENTS/
CN=4A44B1DAC2144A71B732E6D6EA997AB9-32567932-C6>
Subject: CA submission request next week and avoidable exam deferral
Date: 16 May 2025 at 01:07:09

Hi Zaffar, Karla, and Jack,

Thank you very much for your supportive email. I am very sorry for my delay in responding, especially now after reading your email and seeing that you were probably waiting on my rescheduling and with 26th of May now much closer.

Zaffar and Karla, aware of such a short time between now and the 26th of May for you to have time to view it after submission and then carry out the interview, could it be possible for me to submit the joint project by Wednesday and the interview Thursday or Friday, and the Programming CA3 web scraping for Friday? Or something like that.

That is what I hope to work towards now over the weekend. I have made significant progress on both assignments, and would like to try and get them submitted next week rather than a separate assignment over the summer. I understand that that might be unfeasible for you to meet your other obligations and 26th of May deadline.

My joint project is based on data sourced from the UK's [Department for Education](#) data on A-level performance from 2021-2023 identified by each school's Unique Reference Number and Local Layer Super Output Area (LAOA)

My Programming CA3 is scraping Leaving Certificate showing achievement over the years and possibly relevant factors such as gender, from [examinations.ie](#)

Zaffar's quick response and previous positive feedback discussing my original dataset was supportive and now clearly I can see you and Jack tried your best to help me get this joint project submitted. Karla's feedback on my CA1 and CA2 was very helpful in me feeling less anxious about submissions. Thank you.

I advised the Disability Office on Monday that I was unable even to read your reply and that I feared my disability would stop me attending the statistics exam tomorrow. An exam I felt prepared for, but I felt I required assistance in communicating with you with regards to assignments/exams/deferrals. I was given no empathy or support from them at all, solely advised to contact you lecturers by myself which is specifically what my disability can at times stop me from doing. I was treated as though I wasn't disabled and me reaching out to them was an annoyance. I tried to advocate for myself to the disability officer funded to advocate for me during my needs assessment and again this week and failed.

Now after a week of emotional flashbacks and distress due to that dismissal, day of tears building up courage to open Jack's email and the trying to write this email alone (despite me explaining that trying to force myself to communicate on this CA topic without support as my exam draws nearer could exacerbate my disability) I am now in a position where I am forced to defer my statistics exam.

That is something I am told I must do through my lecturers only first and not try and request support from the Disability Office themselves in doing so. The learning agreement here states that must be done between me and my lecturer, but when I am triggered/anxious my communication with my lecturer is more hindered than my communication with my disability advisor. As I tried to explain multiple times to them, the learning agreement that I have here is in contrast with what the University of Galway and I informed would accommodate my specific disability.

My initial contact with Zaffar on the 28th of April was due to a very triggering incident that occurred on the 22nd of April, exacerbating my disability unexpectedly within one week of the joint project submission. I tried to overcome my disability and submit but failed to. Due to how my learning agreement is worded and strongly emphasised I then was unable to bring myself to communicate further with Zaffar, through no fault of his own, as outlined in my learning agreement I arrange any and all accommodations as much as 2 weeks in advance, the emphasis on deadlines further causing anxiety rather than focusing on the topic at hand which I enjoy and am good at. This agreement does not accommodate my disability, it actively hinders it. I am not being pedantic or petty. I am disabled in a very specific way that I have persistently tried to outline to the Disability Office. I tried to speak out for help the day before an assignment, my lecturer was kind but I couldn't follow up due to how my learning agreement implies that I am irresponsible for my own learning reaching out at such short notice - when I felt capable.

I have a diagnosis of complex post traumatic stress disorder which is a type of anxiety disorder, for which I have received Disability Allowance for 7 years due to consistent and professional support from the counselling service and disability office of the University of Galway. This was primarily caused due to abuse experienced as a child, later as an adult, and then by being one of the main primary palliative carers of my grandfather for 3 months at the age of 21 - an isolating experience that resulted in an inability to communicate, to ask for support, to feel capable, to face challenges. The head of counselling of the University of Galway and my disability advisor they went out of their way to write me a letter for me to share with my disability advisor here, and with my lecturers (if I wish), as attached.

The learning agreement there put accommodations for in-person exams were automatically in place for all 12 maths

exams in my final 2 years and did not require me to seek special attention from my lecturer in advance. I did not have to predict at least 2 weeks in advance of an assignment or exam how my disability could effect me the day before. If there were issues on the approach to my exam or assignment I could discuss this with my a single disability advisor who knew me, who could help me communicate with lecturers, reasonably accommodating my disability. It is NOT unreasonable to ask an non-disabled disability officer to communicate between a mentally disabled student and their lecturer via email at some point when they have time. Rather than that student having to open old wounds again and again, requesting accommodations from each individual lecturer directly, worrying will something trigger his disability next semester and cause him to have to again try to exacerbate his disability just to access accommodations mandated by law. My learning agreement / needs assessment at the University of Galway explained how my disability can effect my studies in a way that informed my lecturers if that was necessary. Avoiding me having to try and navigate emotional flashbacks like this while discussing deadlines directly with my lecturers without the support of a disability officer. Avoiding putting the burden on me the disabled student as funded by the Fund for Students with Disabilities. The University of Galway were the first to suggest I had a disability, helped me get diagnosed, supported me with counselling and specific accommodations for 7 years, as outlined in their letter to inform the disability office and my educators in DKIT. Letters as well as my testimony as to how my disability effects me that the Disability Office have only partially acknowledged in their needs assessment, ignoring any later correction by the person actually limited by an invisible disability.

NUIG Counselling

"Anxiety has been a constant challenge for Cian and would particularly come to the fore during stressful situations such as **when assignments were due, before exams**, job interviews, and some social situations. Cian's pattern during these times

was to procrastinate and avoid the stressful situation. Cian always used his time in counselling well and **engaged insightfully with his own wellbeing**. He has also **engaged with the Disability Service** in the university."

NUIG Disability Service

"Cian has an ongoing anxiety disorder that required him to avail of reasonable accommodations to support his studies. Cian received exam accommodations, in class supports (leniency with deadlines for his assignments), **support and advocacy from his disability advisor** and referral to other supports as necessary (counselling and the student health unit)."

As shown, right before exams or assignments being due is when it is most difficult for me to contact lecturers themselves and ask for special attention, support, or to communicate about my struggles. This is in contrast with the learning agreement I have here at DKIT which I tried to advise last year would hurt my mental health not help it.

DKIT:

"Cian may require an extension to deadlines and will request from lectures in advance.**

Smaller venue and extra time (10 mins per hr)

**This will be requested following consultation with lecturer, by student if needed 2 weeks before through the following link: [Request for Reasonable Accommodations in CA Exam/Assessment \(office.com\)](#)*

*** communication to lecturers may be via email or Moodle, whichever is appropriate and acceptable.*

The student also undertakes to respond promptly to any

communication from the Disability Office.

The above accommodations do not absolve you from being ultimately responsible for your own learning."

There is more emphasis here on further requests, further re-expressing trauma, further triggering emotional flashbacks by not having the accommodations in place until I request them. It doesn't make sense. I have always taken responsibility for my own learning, but I have requested multiple times from the Disability Office not to force me to speak to lecturers alone during the most stressful times.

I asked for help from the Disability Office on Monday to avoid having to defer my exam. I was dismissed, not advised perhaps a counselling session might help, or perhaps it might be a good time to get those exam accommodations in place before the exam to lessen anxiety. That dismissal by them at that sensitive time does far more long lasting damage to a disabled person's educational self-efficacy than you might believe.

I met with my psychiatrist on the 8th of May, who's secretary is the one who organises Dr's notes and who isn't available until next Tuesday.

The attached deferral form, requiring clear grounds and documents of evidence to be submitted within 5 days of the end of the exam period however it shouldn't be used in relation to "issues related to student disability which have already been dealt with through the Disability Office".

I will have a medical note provided and the form ready to submit to hopefully defer only my statistics exam. I should not be required to go through those steps though. A disabled person need not have a doctor's note to request reasonable accommodation from a publicly funded Disability Office. I should

have received support from the Disability Office after I said repeatedly that I would struggle to communicate directly with lecturers at times regarding assignments or exams effected by my disability. I do not have trouble communicating about exams or assignment not related to my disability.

I am not an expert in mental health but I had been receiving specific and reasonable accomodations in the University of Galway that lead to me achieving a first-class honours in modules of Sociology, Psychology and Philosophy of Education. I do very well know what funding, frameworks and supports are shared throughout all tertiary level institutions and what requests are reasonable and what dismissals are not.

My disability has not been dealt with reasonably by the Disability Office. Despite great communication and support from my lecturers, I shouldn't feel forced to disclose all this to seek support from my lecturers by myself when I would rather keep my academic communications and communications of disability separate for the benefit of mental health disability that has been shown to the Disability Office as effecting communication and requiring the support of a Disability Officer.

The emphasis placed on and in my learning agreement ignoring my and others' explanation of how my disability effects me, my request for assistance from my Disability Officer denied, only allowing me to resolve issues pertaining to my disability directly with my lecturers first does not meet the needs of students with anxiety and post-traumatic stress disorders that effect their ability to communicate and ask for help, nor the advice given to HEIs outlined in ['The Role of the Disability Officer and the Disability Service in Higher Education in Ireland: A Vision for Future Development' \(McCarthy et al., 2018\)](#) and ['Fund for Students with Disabilities: Guidelines for Higher Education Institutions' \(HEA, 2024\)](#)

I enjoy python and statistics far more than trying to advocate

alone for myself when arrangements are meant to be in place in advance to avoid that. That is what my disability officer should have advised me to focus on, instead of telling me to do alone the exact thing I said I needed help doing. The condition in the learning agreement requiring me to request exam time each time in advance from each lecturer show a lack of understanding of how anxiety and trauma disorders effect identity and communication. The condition in the learning agreement requiring me to only arrange accommodations with my lecturers alone is isolatory and ignorant of the evidenced and complex history of my anxiety and struggles in University and life over the past 10 years that was explained to the Disability Office at length during the needs assessment and when I tried to appeal the fact my needs were not being met by the conditions of the accommodations, expecting invisibly disabled students to do something you think is easy but they've shown evidence is hard for them is not a resonable accommodation.

The goal of this week could have been progressing on some python scraping pdf scraping and parsing, finishing up the statistical analysis of computer science achievement in disadvantaged schools for my joint project, and buying a calculator and new pen, and making sure ai get enough sleep for my exam.

Instead I had to spend Monday/Tuesday/Wednesday/Thursday feeling isolated and alone incapable of opening or responding to Jack's email but gasligting my own disability to do so because that was the only advice the Disability Office cared to give. I should not have to retraumatise myself like this alone trying to get 2 CAs submitted and now an exam deferred. Regardless of what is outlined in a learning agreement, if another student sends an email such as this to the Disability Office in future in an effort to avoid having to defer an exam I sincerely hope the Diaability Office will actively try to support them instead of saying the equivalent of 'tough, I can't help you, don't be

disabled and send the email you said you couldn't send due to your disability':

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>
Date: 12 May 2025 at 15:45:33 IST
To: Disability <disability@dkit.ie>
Subject: Informing of difficulties exacerbating mental health disability

Due to unexpected events in my home life triggering my disability I have struggled to submit my latest Statistics/Programming assignment and I am just contacting you to keep you updated as there is also a final Programming assignment to submit.

I previously contacted my Statistics lecturer to advise him of my inability to submit the Statistics and Programming joint project advising him that I had an appointment with my psychiatrist last week. He asked me when I would be able to submit, and he also gave a further week's extension for the entire class but I still have not been able to revisit the work I've done or re-read his email or get back in touch since then, at times my anxiety can make simple tasks feel insurmountable.

Currently I am trying to focus on studying for a Statistics exam upcoming this Friday.

But as this exam draws nearer, even though I have passed previous modules with similar topics before, I can feel my anxiety levels rising and causing avoidance/procrastination. I certainly still hope to attend on Friday but I worry that my anxiety and procrastination will increase to a degree that not only do I not sit the exam but then also do not continue working on the joint project and programming assignments that I previously enjoyed progressing on.

I am not sure of the process or best next steps right now, I have another appointment with my psychiatrist this week who advised also that she would provide me with a letter if necessary to show that I am getting ongoing support etc for my mental health disability.

Thanks for your time, mise le meas,
Cian

Mise san oideachas, le meas agus míchumas,
Cian Mac Liatháin

From: Jack Mc Donnell <Jack.McDonnell@dkit.ie>
Sent: Tuesday, April 29, 2025 10:05 AM
To: Zaffar Haider Janjua <Zaffar.Haider@dkit.ie>; Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>
Cc: Karla Anielá Cepeda Zapata <Karla.Cepeda@dkit.ie>

Subject: Re: Delay in submission of joint project Re:
Identification of Project Dataset

Hi Zaffar and Cian,

Thank you for the email. I am sorry to hear you are having trouble, Cian. It sounds like it will not be possible to do the presentation at the original time. [@Zaffar Haider Janjua](#), if you and Karla (cc'd) can facilitate Cian at a later date in May that would be great. Please note that grades for each module must be finalised by May 26th.

The other option is to do the project over the summer as a repeat CA and do the presentation in September.

Please let me know what you intend to do and if I can help.

All the best,
Jack

From: Zaffar Haider Janjua <Zaffar.Haider@dkit.ie>
Sent: Tuesday 29 April 2025 09:27
To: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>; Jack Mc Donnell <Jack.McDonnell@dkit.ie>
Subject: Re: Delay in submission of joint project Re:
Identification of Project Dataset

Hello Cian,

I am sorry to hear that. Could you please let me know when it would be possible for you to submit your work?

Let me also introduce you to Dr. Jack Mc Donnell, who is the programme coordinator for the course.

[@Jack Mc Donnell](#), Could you please advise us on how to proceed with Cian's case? The interviews are scheduled for the 1st and 2nd of May, and I am concerned that we are working

with a very tight timeline as we also need to conclude the semester.

Thank you very much for your kind support.

Best regards,

Dr. Zaffar H. Janjua

Senior Researcher,
Regulated Software Research Center (RSRC),
Dundalk Institute of Technology,
zaffar.haider@dkit.ie

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>
Sent: Monday, April 28, 2025 9:24 PM
To: Zaffar Haider Janjua <Zaffar.Haider@dkit.ie>
Subject: Delay in submission of joint project Re: Identification of Project Dataset

Hi Zaffar,

I am contacting you with regard to the joint project as unfortunately over the past couple of weeks I have been struggling with my post traumatic stress disorder effecting my ability to carry out tasks that I typically am able to do. I am registered with the disability office as unfortunately my disorder can sometimes effect my ability to face assignments or deadlines without overwhelming anxiety.

I had hoped to submit my joint project tonight as expected but these last few weeks but especially last few days have been difficult for mental health reasons. I am not sure what the process is for submitting the project and attending the

presentation/interview at a later date is but I am unable to progress or focus on it right now.

I have a psychiatrist appointment scheduled for the 8th of May, and will be able to discuss with them then to hopefully improve the situation exacerbating my mental health.

Sometimes overwhelming anxiety makes it difficult to communicate but I thought I should send this email to let you know as I am unable to submit or attend this week.

Thanks for your time, mise le meas,
Cian

On 8 Apr 2025, at 11:00, Cian Mac Liatháin
<D00274413@student.dkit.ie> wrote:

Hi, sorry, can you send it again I can't see it anywhere

On 8 Apr 2025, at 10:54, Zaffar Haider Janjua
<Zaffar.Haider@dkit.ie> wrote:

Hello Cian,
Are you available for the meeting now. I just sent you the meeting link

Best regards,

Dr. Zaffar H. Janjua

Senior Researcher,
Regulated Software Research Center (RSRC),

Dundalk Institute of Technology,
zaffar.haider@dkit.ie

<Outlook-4v0gxaia.png>

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>

Sent: Monday, April 7, 2025 12:25 PM

To: Zaffar Haider Janjua <Zaffar.Haider@dkit.ie>

Subject: Re: Identification of Project Dataset

Yes no problem, see you at 11.

On 7 Apr 2025, at 12:18, Zaffar Haider Janjua
<Zaffar.Haider@dkit.ie> wrote:

Hello Cian,

Can we have a meeting tomorrow morning to discuss it? Are you available at 11 am tomorrow morning?

Best regards,

Dr. Zaffar H. Janjua

Senior Researcher,
Regulated Software Research Center (RSRC),
Dundalk Institute of Technology,
zaffar.haider@dkit.ie

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From: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>

Sent: Monday, April 7, 2025 12:16 PM

To: Zaffar Haider Janjua <Zaffar.Haider@dkit.ie>

Subject: Re: Identification of Project Dataset

Hi Zaffar,

I could not link the entire dataset as it is 514TB updated with daily pypi downloads since 2021

<Screenshot 2025-04-07 at 12.06.30.png>

The link to the full public dataset on BigQuery is here:

Google Cloud console
cloud.google.com

[<defaul
t.png>](#)

The sample csvs and the schema I attached are the type sof pypi package downloads I want to investigate over time

The core parts of the schema are:

Column	Description	Examples
timestamp	Date and time	2020-03-09 00:33:03 UTC
file.project	Project name	pipenv, nose
file.version	Package version	0.1.6, 1.4.2
details.installer.name	Installer	pip, bandersnatch
details.python	Python version	2.7.12, 3.6.4

Do you think this is unsuitable?

On 7 Apr 2025, at 11:58, Zaffar Haider Janjua
<Zaffar.Haider@dkit.ie> wrote:

Hello Cian,

I can see that you've been putting a lot of effort into searching for a suitable dataset, which I really appreciate. However, I'm still waiting to see a complete dataset in the attached files, specifically one that contains clearly defined features or variables with corresponding values. I would recommend visiting [Kaggle.com](https://www.kaggle.com), where you can find a wide range of well-structured datasets that are ready to use for analysis.

If you'd like, I'd be happy to arrange a short online meeting to discuss and guide you through the selection process. Please let me know if that would be helpful, as I can see this task has been delayed for a while now.

Best regards,

Dr. Zaffar H. Janjua

Senior Researcher,
Regulated Software Research Center (RSRC),
Dundalk Institute of Technology,
zaffar.haider@dkit.ie

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From: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>
Sent: Monday, April 7, 2025 11:38 AM
To: Zaffar Haider Janjua <Zaffar.Haider@dkit.ie>
Subject: Re: Identification of Project Dataset

Sorry, I was struggling at the time to arrange a proper example as I didn't have my laptop. Only just got it back.

I have attached some sample outputs based on the following queries:

pypi_downloads schema:

```
SELECT
    column_name,
    data_type
FROM
    `bigquery-public-
data`.pypi.INFORMATION_SCHEMA.COLUMNS
WHERE
    table_name = 'file_downloads';
```

Most recent 100 lancedb downloads:

```
SELECT
    *
FROM
    `bigquery-public-data`.pypi.file_downloads
WHERE
    DATE(timestamp) = CURRENT_DATE()
    AND file.project = 'lancedb'
LIMIT 100;
```

Most recent 100 chromadb downloads:

```
SELECT
    *
FROM
    `bigquery-public-data`.pypi.file_downloads
WHERE
    DATE(timestamp) = CURRENT_DATE()
    AND file.project = 'chromadb'
LIMIT 100;
```

Most recent duckdb downloads from Ireland:

```
SELECT
    *
FROM
    `bigquery-public-data`.pypi.file_downloads
WHERE
    DATE(timestamp) = CURRENT_DATE()
    AND file.project = 'duckdb'
    AND country_code = 'IE'
LIMIT 100;
```

The results show information like which installer was used, which python version, which operating system. I hope to compare certain packages over time to see trends in popularity like if there are unexpected older versions most popular, or if certain databases are more popular in certain locations etc

If you think this is unsuitable I will gladly accept any suggested dataset

Mise le meas,
Cian

On 7 Apr 2025, at 06:43, Zaffar Haider Janjua
<Zaffar.Haider@dkit.ie> wrote:

Hello Cian,

I cannot see proper data in the attached file. I am afraid I am unable to guide you with the information provided.

Best regards,

Dr. Zaffar H. Janjua

Senior Researcher,
Regulated Software Research Center (RSRC),
Dundalk Institute of Technology,
zaffar.haider@dkit.ie

<Outlook-ktcpw5xm.png>

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>
Sent: Monday, March 31, 2025 12:30 AM
To: Zaffar Haider Janjua <Zaffar.Haider@dkit.ie>
Subject: Re: Identification of Project Dataset

Attached
is a csv from the dataset

On 28 Mar 2025, at 10:15, Zaffar Haider Janjua
<Zaffar.Haider@dkit.ie> wrote:

Hello Cian,

Can you please send me a sample from this dataset so that I can comment on it.

Thank you.

Dr. Zaffar H. Janjua

Senior Researcher,
Regulated Software Research Center (RSRC),
Dundalk Institute of Technology,
zaffar.haider@dkit.ie

<Outlook-1b0zjuq0.png>

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>

Sent: Thursday, March 27, 2025 9:09 PM

To: Zaffar Haider Janjua <Zaffar.Haider@dkit.ie>; Karla
Aniela Cepeda Zapata <Karla.Cepeda@dkit.ie>

Subject: Identification of Project Dataset

My proposed dataset is the PyPI Downloads dataset
available via BigQuery:

docs.pypi.org



I plan to compare number of different popular package
downloads over time and try and predict number of
downloads in the future, and compare different details of
the downloads e.g. which python version, which operating
system were used

Mise le meas

Cian



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